

— EDITION 06

# KEY PLAYERS: MEXICO V SOUTH AFRICA — BY THE NUMBERS

*Six players who decide the opener — the numbers they bring to the Azteca.*

A 6-part breakdown

SWIPE ►►►

0101 / 06

# | RAÚL JIMÉNEZ — STRIKER

123 caps · 44 goals — second only to Borgetti on Mexico's all-time list. Scored the equaliser v USA in the 2025 Gold Cup final. *El Lobo leads the line.*



0202 / 06

# SANTIAGO GIMÉNEZ —

## STRIKER

47 caps · 6 goals · AC Milan. Two-time Gold Cup winner, scored the 2023 final winner. *The sharpest movement in the box.*





0303 / 06

# | EDSON ÁLVAREZ — 🇲🇽 CAPTAIN

95 caps · the single pivot in Aguirre's 4-3-3.  
Breaks play up, shields the back four. *The captain sets the tempo.*





0404 / 06

# | LYLE FOSTER — 🇿🇦 STRIKER

26 caps · 10 goals · Burnley. Bafana's most productive forward of this era — the focal point asked to deliver at altitude. *Their ceiling rises with him.*



0505 / 06

# TEBOHO MOKOENA —

## MIDFIELD

51 caps · 9 goals · Mamelodi Sundowns.  
Controls tempo and a genuine set-piece  
threat from deep. *The heartbeat of the side.*



0606 / 06

# | PERCY TAU — 🇿🇦 FORWARD

The ex-Brighton man, Bafana's creative spark — flair and European pedigree to unlock a game in transition. *The one who makes something from nothing.*





— THE TAKEAWAY

# YOUR ONE TO WATCH?

Drop it in the comments — and follow @fifa.archv for the daily tournament archive.